

up. "These ARM processors have nine different cores and are based on the technology where all other cores are in sleep mode when one core is performing, enabling minimal power wastage," elaborates Shravan. "The processor is two-three times power efficient, providing a backup probably better than any other device," adds Shravan.

Better performance for video/graphic. Tegra, well known for graphic capabilities, makes Adam a high-end gaming device. It is ten times faster than processors used in smartphones today and can play 1080p video. Its Geforce graphics core is expected to allow even 3D gaming. "Its high performance allows to play three 1080 videos simultaneously without any computing hassles, giving days of battery life," says Shravan.

Better camera and track pad. The 3.2-megapixel camera is capable of standard video and image capture. Swivel function allows it to act as both front and back camera. The built-in track pad at the back of Adam gives you more options to control the cursor or functions of the tablet PC.

The power of Android. Today, numerous devices are based on Android. Adam is the new chip on the Android block. But how has Android helped Adam? "We used Android as it is tweakable to the core, opening possibilities for developments. Moreover, we believe in giving back to the society and Android serves the best purpose by inviting anybody and everybody to create whatever is best suited for them," says Shravan.

"Today, users seek ease instead of availability and performance instead of processing. Keeping that in mind, we wanted to abandon drop-down menus and folder hierarchies and deliver our own set of office applications which will be simpler and faster. Android makes this possible," adds Shravan.

However, Adam experiment with Android wasn't easy, especially because this operating system isn't designed for large devices with large screens. "Most of the applications

Road to Android gadget

Starting to build the Adam dream in 2008, Notion Ink took one year to come up with the design, requirements and proposed technologies to make the device a reality. "We worked with National Institute of Design, Research and Development Campus at Bengaluru, to come up with the user understanding, elements of the next-generation operating system, user interface and product concept. After six months of core research, we got what we wanted. For hardware, we collaborated with industry leaders in the US and Taiwan. We got into business collaboration with nVidia for their next-generation Tegra processors. For the touch screens, we went for TPK," says Shravan.

And like for all startups, the path for Notion Ink too wasn't easy. Finding engineering talent was a huge challenge. "India doesn't have people working on Android. Those who do, charge Rs 100,000 per resource per month," says Shravan, who decided to train engineers from scratch to overcome this hurdle. The company trained engineers from BVRIT in Bachupally, Hyderabad.

Further, they had to be ready to face tough competition from other players in the market. The company is working on application store platform of its own, to ensure that its users get the best variety of content and it is able to compete with other players. "We have the necessary collaborations in place, which will make the availability of content lot easier, be it digital books, songs, movies, applications or even media content," says Shravan.

available in the Android market place are meant for the small-size screens, which is why we will release our own SDK simultaneously with the product launch. It will allow developers to develop applications for bigger screens. We have redesigned Android, its UI and fixed resolution issues," says Shravan, who is confident of achieving excellent applications and competing with the exhaustive Apple store.

Apple Vs Adam

But will Adam be able to withstand Apple's might in the tablet PC space? Apple's iPad has been criticised on various aspects and Notion Ink is trying to face the Apple might by tackling those sores via Adam. Apple's iPad runs on iMac's proprietary OS using a normal LCD screen with Apple's own processor. Adam, powered by nVidia's Tegra 2 chipset, is able to run the same hardware as iPad effectively two-three times longer. The Pi Qixel display further improves its longevity. Further, "Adam can do 1080p HD video, while iPad is believed to do somewhere around 560p," says Shravan. Adam is also slimmer than iPad (13.4mm), runs Flash and comes with USB ports.

But with Apple strong on the application front, what is Notion Ink's strategy to win the battle? "We are coming up with an Application Development

Challenge to accelerate applications for Adam. The competition and our soon-to-be released business model will make Adam strong on the application front and not just dependant on applications developed for Android devices," says Shravan.

As far as the business model is concerned, Notion Ink shall soon put down those cards too. "Right now the information on our business model is not available in public domain. However, we will be doing a public release soon. The challenge along with our business model (to be revealed soon with the competition) will help to motivate developers for creating applications for our device," says Shravan.

Looking ahead!

With every possible problem for the tablet PC user imagined and kept in mind, Adam is sure to give a new twist to the tablet PC market. But when can we expect the Adam magic to spread in India and globally? "We are going to manufacture devices in Taiwan. Our US launch is expected to be in June-July time frame. The Indian launch might, however, take a couple of months from there," says Shravan.

The tablet PC war is surely on. May the best technology win! ●

The author is a business correspondent at EYF Bengaluru